Lepanto Game



The battle of Lepanto, Andrea Michieli "il Vicentino" 1595-1605
Oil painting on canvas
Venice, Palazzo Ducale – Scrutiny room

The battle of Lepanto (island of Greece) on 7 October 1571 saw as protagonists the Christian fleets of the Republic of Venice, the Spanish Empire, Genoa and Lucca, the Papal State, the Knights of Malta, the Duchies of Savoy, Urbino, Mantua, Ferrara and the Grand Duchy of Tuscany. This alliance was called the "Holy League" by Pope Pius V and achieved a crushing victory over the fleet of the Ottoman Empire, led by Ali Pasha who, on that occasion, was killed.

The Holy League was led by Don Giovanni of Austria, natural son of Spanish emperor Carlo V and admiral of the fleet; however, the Venetians were undoubtedly the masters, deploying the flagship of the Arsenal's naval technology: the galleys.

Unlike normal galleys, the six galleys deployed by the Serenissima were armored not only at the bow and stern, but also along the sides to protect the oarsmen. Furthermore, they deployed as many as forty guns along their entire length, from stern to bow, on both sides. Sebastiano Venier, Captain of the sea of the lagoon Republic (later Doge), also increased the number of arquebusiers on board the galleys, making them deadly war machines, with unrivaled firepower for the time.

News traveled quickly even at the time, so it is not surprising if - once back home - the Venetian captains and their respective crews found a game waiting for them to celebrate their victory.

At that time, gambling was widespread throughout the territory of the Republic and the spread of movable type printing and paper had allowed costs to be reduced so that it was very easy to find gambling sheets for sale at printers that the tavern keepers made available to customers.

Historically, the battle of Lepanto was a turning point in the contrast between two worlds: on the one hand the Christian European one and on the other the Muslim one of the Ottomans, with the supremacy of the former overtaking the latter.

One last curiosity: once the outcome of the battle was known, Pope Pius V proclaimed the Feast of the Our Lady of Victory for 7 October, a holiday whose name his successor Gregory XIII changed to the

Feast of the Our Lady of the Rosary, still celebrated today in particular way in the territory of the province of Venice with village festivals dedicated to it.

PURPOSE OF THE GAME

The aim of the game is to win all the stakes.

GAME'S RULES

This is a game for an unlimited number of players, the number of tokens provided with the skin is enough for two to have fun.

Starting with an empty board, the players determine the stakes (for example one token each) and place it on the lion of Saint Mark.

You take turns rolling the dice and based on the result obtained you pay or withdraw the number of tokens indicated by the corresponding character.

Corresponding to each character, indicated by the number given by the roll of the dice, there is an indication:

P followed by a number

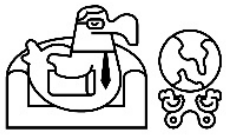
T followed by a number

P stands for pay, the player will have to add the indicated number of chips to the pot.

T stands for "tira", that it means "withdraw" in Venetian dialect: in this case the player will withdraw the indicated number of tokens from the pot.

When a player runs out of tokens, he is out of the game.

When a player gets a 12 by throwing the dice he "rolls everything", that is, he takes the whole pot and the game ends.



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